



Double podium: Neeraj Chopra finished second in the men's javelin throw final with a season-best effort of 85.83m, while Yash Vir Singh produced a personal best of 85.41m with his final attempt to clinch bronze. PTI&REUTERS

45 of the 46 athletics disciplines at the 2010 Games. In Glasgow, because of restrictions on the size of the competition, only 32 Indian athletes competed across 18 of the 43 events. Yet a much higher proportion of those who made the trip to Scotland ended up on the podium.

More importantly, the medals came from a wider spread of events than has traditionally been the case. Indian athletics has often relied heavily on a handful of established stars and individual events. In Glasgow, the podium finishes came from the decathlon, high jump, triple jump, javelin and long-distance

running. That breadth is perhaps the most encouraging aspect of the campaign.

Tejaswin became the first Indian to win a decathlon medal at the Games, taking bronze in an event that demands excellence across 10 disciplines. Kushare bettered India's previous best in the men's high jump, Tejaswin's own bronze from Birmingham 2022, with a silver of his own, the country's first in the event. Gulveer Singh then added two more historic firsts, winning silver in the 10,000m and bronze in the 5000m.

Gulveer's double was arguably the most significant performance of the Games from an Indian perspective.

His medals represented a breakthrough in two events in which India has traditionally had little presence at the Commonwealth level. They also underline the rapid progress made by the 28-year-old, who will head to the Asian Games as a genuine gold-medal contender in both events.

Sarvesh, meanwhile, produced his breakthrough on a bitterly cold evening at Scotstoun Stadium. His medal-winning height of 2.25m was below the 2.31m he had cleared earlier in the season, but the conditions and timing of the competition make the performance all the more notable.